This is a level 3 Research Aid
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Wageningen University & Research

Abstract

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Description

From the early 20th century the Agricultural College in Wageningen (now: Wageningen University & Research) had a museum display of objects from the Dutch East Indies, which was used in teaching geography and ethnology. The collection was expanded with acquisitions and donations by individuals, dealers and museums. For example, there was a donation from the collections of the Koninklijke Militaire Academie (Royal Military Academy) in Breda in 1914, what was then the Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde donated a collection of Papua objects in 1941, and in 1948 what was then the Colonial Institute donated a collection of Indonesian objects . In addition the private collection of Frits Herman van Naerssen, a lecturer at the Agricultural College, was on display from about 1946 to 1953. Much of the Agricultural College collection was lost during the Second World War but was built up again after the war. After Indonesia's independence in 1949 the college shifted the focus of its teaching to other countries. Around 1960 almost the entire collection was given on loan to the Stedelijk Gymnasium Schiedam and from 1962 the collection was divided between the Gymnasium in Schiedam and the Ethnographic Museum in Delft (later Museum Nusantara). The objects in Schiedam were transferred to the Wereldmuseum in Rotterdam in 1997 and the objects in Delft ended up with various museums after Museum Nusantara closed in 2013 .

Provenance research

Objects from the collection of the Agricultural College that were on loan to the Stedelijk Gymnasium Schiedam can often be identified by a number beginning with SCH written on the object.

The archives of the Agricultural College until 1959 are held in the Gelders Archief. The archive of the Agricultural College from 1959 onwards is still at the university and is managed by the OS Document Management and Logistics department of Wageningen University & Research. The Wereldmuseum Rotterdam has correspondence relating to the transfer of objects to and by the Stedelijk Gymnasium Schiedam and the Ethnographic Museum Delft and this is held in the digital record of Wageningen University & Research.

The museum archives also contain records relating to the 1941 donation of objects from Irian Jaya (collection C.C.F.M. Le Roux) by the Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde. The Dutch National Archive holds records on the sale of objects by the Indisch Instituut (which merged into the later Wereldmuseum Amsterdam) in 1948.

Related Aids

see also: Civil servants
see also: Science
see also: Naturalis Biodiversity Center
see also: Museum Nusantara

Primary sources

Archival access: NL-AhGldA 0740 2324
https://permalink.geldersarchief.nl/B6D0CE1E7C674C7CB47662BAEAD8B9DC
Contains documents relating to the ethnographic collection, dated 1941 (on donation of Papua objects from C.C.F.M. Le Roux by RMV) and 1955 (on the future of the collection).

Archival access: NL-AhGldA 0740 2833
https://permalink.geldersarchief.nl/71321F1495A5498EB17DF47AEB28F551
Contains an inventory of the collections and teaching resources of the Department of Geography and Ethnology, created around 1904 and maintained until 1929.

Archival access: NL-AhGldA 0740 1522
https://permalink.geldersarchief.nl/E0E8560A4D3B450A98F7577218312DD9
Contains documents relating to exhibitions, 1947-1956.

Archival access: NL-HaNA 2.20.69 4402

Contains correspondence regarding the sale of objects by the Indisch Instituut (now Wereldmuseum Amsterdam) in 1948.

Secondary sources

Article: “Honderd museumstukken spoorloos verdwenen.” Algemeen Dagblad, 6 augustus 1953.
https://resolver.kb.nl/resolve?urn=MMKB19:000359080:mpeg21:a00086
Article from 1953 about the disappearance of nearly 100 objects from the College of Agriculture collection.

Relevant Data

Identifiers:

https://www.wikidata.org/entity/Q422208, https://hdl.handle.net/20.500.11840/pi256 , Name variations:

Landbouwhogeschool, Rijkslandbouwschool, Landbouwuniversiteit Wageningen , Tags: Activity:

Collection, Museum , Soort objecten:

Ethnographic objects , Geografisch:

Indonesia , Period of activity: Year of start: 1876, Year of end:

, Collections: General remarks: content: The Agricultural College collection was disposed of from about 1962 and dispersed around various institutions. Objects are currently in the Wereldmuseum Amsterdam, Wereldmuseum Leiden, Wereldmuseum Rotterdam and Museum Bronbeek. Objects may also be in other museums, especially when they were part of the collection of Museum Nusantara. , content-type: text/markdown, Within the Data Hub: